

The skull is the most ancient and feared symbol of necromancy.



Necromancer

Class Handbook



The ultimate goal of any necromancer is to ascend to lichdom.

Emissary Skull

You have the skull of a linguist and ambassador. Treated with runes, it retains a shadow of its former knowledge.

If the skull is daubed with blood or other remains taken from a slain creature, it gains the knowledge of all languages that creature speaks. You can speak, understand, and read those languages while you hold the skull. If you use this ability again, the skull loses the prior languages it learned, replacing them with the new ones.

Scythe of Reaping

You imbue a scythe with the energies that simmer between life and death. It becomes a cutting tool that you can use to reap life energy from your enemies. The scythe is a two-handed, reach melee weapon that does 1d6 slashing damage.

In your hands, the weapon uses your Intelligence modifier for its attack and damage bonus.

At higher levels, you gain reaper dice as the scythe's cuts open the gate between life and death. Your reaper dice are 1d6 at level 5, 2d6 at level 7, and 3d6 at level 10.

When you hit a hostile creature with the scythe, you can roll the reaper dice and apply the total as necrotic damage to the target of your attack or as healing to a creature within melee range of you.

Thief's Hands

You have acquired the severed hands of a dead thief and, with your magic, have imbued the thief's cunning into them.

The hands are two Tiny objects with AC 15, 2 hit points each, and a test bonus equal to your Intelligence modifier + your proficiency bonus. They have advantage on all Stealth checks. They have a climb speed.

As an action, you can direct them to open doors, search through treasure piles, and take other actions as you direct. As a search action, you can project your senses through one of them, allowing you to see and hear everything it senses for one round.

The hands understand how to use lock picks and can be directed to pick locks and disable traps if they are carrying the appropriate tools.

Vampiric Harvest

Level: 1 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 120 feet

Target: 1 creature

Duration: 1 round

You infuse an aura of death energy around a creature, allowing you to collect its life energy and share it with an ally.

Once per turn when the target takes damage, you gain one blood point. At the start of your next turn when the spell's duration expires, a creature of your choice within range regains 3 hit points per blood point you collected. You then lose all blood points.

Tools of Death

Death Mask

You weave a ghoulish mask from skin taken from an embalmed corpse. When you wear the mask you gain the following benefits.

When making Charisma checks to influence undead creatures, add your Intelligence modifier as a bonus to the roll.

As a magic attack action, you can stare at a creature within 120 feet and fill it with dread. It must make a Wisdom save. On a failed save, it is frightened of you for one round and takes psychic damage based on your level.

The damage is 1d4 at level 1, 2d4 at level 5, and 3d4 at level 10.

Death-Eyed Skull

You collect a skull and scribe it with blasphemous runes of death and annihilation. You can present the skull and channel power through it, causing a sickly beam of crimson energy to emit from it as a magic attack action. This is an attack against one target with a range of 120 feet that uses your Intelligence modifier on its attack and damage rolls. On a hit, the target comes under a death curse and suffers psychic damage based on your level. While cursed, undead creatures have advantage on attacks against it for one round.

The damage is 1d4 at level 1, 2d4 at level 5, and 3d4 at level 10.

Necromancer

Core Necromancer Traits

Primary Ability	Intelligence
Hit Points	1d6
Saving Throw Proficiencies	Intelligence, Wisdom
Skill Proficiencies	Choose 2 skills
Weapon Proficiencies	Choose 1 category
Starting Equipment	Padded Jacket, Grimoire, Robe, Dagger

Necromancer Features

Lev	Proficie	Ritu	Too	Class Features
1	+2	1	2	Apprentice of Undeath, Tools of Death
2	+2	1	2	—
3	+2	1	2	Ability Bonus
4	+2	2	2	—
5	+2	2	3	Death's Harvest
6	+2	2	3	—
7	+2	3	3	Ability Bonus
8	+2	3	3	—
9	+3	3	3	—
10	+3	3	3	Endless Undeath

The **Rituals** column shows how many rituals you know. The **Tools** column shows how many tools of death you carry. Both increase automatically as shown.

Level 1: Apprentice of Undeath

You have learned to breach the barrier between life and death, commanding the dead to serve you.

Saving Throws. The saving throw DC of your necromancer features is 8 + your Intelligence modifier + your proficiency bonus.

Rituals. You master blasphemous rituals that animate the dead or call forth spirits. Each ritual has a level and your level must be greater than or equal to its level to take it. When you gain a level, you can replace one ritual you know with another.

Controlling the Dead. Each summoned undead has a stat block, including the initiative it acts on (undead do not roll initiative). When you summon an undead, it appears within 30 feet of you and obeys a general command you issue. Undead can perform any task you can describe, but lack specialized knowledge or creativity. They cannot craft new things or work autonomously.

Soul Focus. When you use a ritual to create undead, that ritual requires your soul focus. The next time you use another ritual, the ritual that needed your soul focus ends. You can only have one soul focus ritual active at a time.

Level 1: Tools of Death

Your ability to pierce the veil allows you to craft objects infused with death energy. You gain two tools of death of your choice from the list at the end of this class.

If you lose a tool, you can craft a replacement as part of a long rest; the item is ready when the rest ends. You can replace one tool each long rest.

Dark Arts. If you use your action to use a ritual, you can also use a tool of death that turn without using an additional action.

Level 3: Ability Bonus

You gain a +1 bonus to two abilities of your choice.

Level 5: Death's Harvest

Once per turn when a creature within 30 feet of you dies, you regain hit points equal to your Intelligence modifier.

Level 7: Ability Bonus

You gain a +1 bonus to two abilities of your choice.

Level 10: Endless Undeath

At the start of your turn, any undead created by your currently active soul focus ritual that were destroyed return to unlife with full hit points.

Rituals

Rituals that require your soul focus note that in their duration entry.

Animate Zombies

Level: 1 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 30 feet

Duration: Permanent (Soul Focus)

You call forth spirits of the dead to animate nearby corpses up to size Medium. If you invoke this ritual and already have zombies animated with it, you animate additional ones until you reach your limit. You animate one zombie at level 1, two at level 5, and three at level 9.

AC 12 — **HP** 12 — **Tests** +0 (Str, Con +2) — 30 feet

Death Proof (15+). When reduced to 0 hit points by damage other than radiant, roll a d20. On 15+ it is instead reduced to 1 hit point.

Initiative 5: Rend and Tear. Melee attack with attack bonus of your proficiency + Intelligence modifier. **Hit:** 1d8 bludgeoning damage.

Animate Skeletons

Level: 3 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 30 feet

Duration: Permanent (Soul Focus)

You conjure forth the spirits of slain warriors to animate skeletons up to size Medium. If you invoke this ritual and already have skeletons animated with it, you animate additional ones until you reach your limit. You animate one skeleton at level 3, two at level 6, and three at level 10.

AC 16 — **HP** 8 — **Tests** +0 (Dex +2) — 30 feet

Death Splinters. If killed by a melee attack, the creature that destroyed it takes 1d8 piercing damage.

Initiative 20: Slashing Claws. Melee attack with attack bonus of your proficiency + Intelligence modifier. **Hit:** 1d6 slashing damage.

Call Wrathful Ghost

Level: 7 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 30 feet

Duration: Permanent (Soul Focus)

You draw the ghost of someone who died a painful death. The spirit manifests using the stats below.

AC 13 — **HP** 25 — **Tests** +1 (Cha +4) — 40 feet (Fly)

Incorporeal. Can move through but cannot end a turn inside a solid object.

Insubstantial (16+). The first time this creature takes damage on a turn, roll a d20. On 16+ it takes no damage that turn.

Initiative 10: Frightening Howl. Hostile creatures in melee range must make a Wisdom save using necromancer's save DC. **Failure:** 1d4 psychic damage per 2 necromancer levels, and frightened of the ghost for 1 round. **Success:** Half damage

Curse of Death's Doorstep

Level: 10 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 120 feet

Target: 1 creature

Duration: 3 rounds

You weave necromantic energy through a creature's spirit, sending tendrils into the future to draw its death hurtling toward it. The target creature gains a death curse, its life energy bleeding away each time death comes to call. Once per round when a creature within 30 feet of it dies, it takes 3d12 necrotic damage.

Gaze of the Bloody Skull

Level: 7 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 30 feet

Duration: 1 round

The skin covering your skull peels back, revealing a horrid, bloody mask that leaves creatures shrieking in terror. Creatures of your choice within 30 feet of you must make Wisdom saves. On a failed save, a creature is frightened of you and cannot move closer to you.